

**MMEMME NA
OMENALA ND! IGBO**



•Ígù Áhà /ikuputanwa

Igbo child naming ceremony. This is an important culture of the Igbo people. It is done between 7 to 12 days. Most people choose the 8 day because to is the last day of the 2nd week.

- On that day, there will be erimeri (Such as ụtara ji, Ji mmir ọkụ, ofe dgz) ọjị for prayers, ose ọjị, ite nzu.



In those days, you would see names like:

Nweke

Nworie

Nwoye

Nwafọ

Nwankwọ

Mgbeke (Born on eke
day. Mgbe eke)

Mgborie

Mgbafo

Mgbankwọ

Okeke

Okoreke

Okorie

Okafo

Okenkwọ

Ịlụ Nwaanyị

Ịlụ Nwaanyị is the Igbo traditional marriage ceremony. It could be seen the entire process to follow traditionally for a man and a woman to become married.

There are different stages of this ceremony.



i. Ikụ aka n'ụzọ/ knocking on the door.

This is the first stage in the igbo marriage process. The intending groom visits the family of his intended bride to be. He would go with a few members of his family. They make their interest known by telling the family that their son have found a daughter ogf the family pleasing. It is also here they try to find out if there is availbilty on the girls side... that is to be sure she is not already engage with someone else, or if their son would find favor in the eyes of the lady to allow them come again.

ii. **Ijụ ese: Investigation .**

After *ịkụ* aka *n'ụzọ*, the family of both the intended bride and the intended groom begin the process of *ijụ ese*. This is a kind of investigation to understand the history and background of their intended partner. In this investigation, they try to find out if there is any ill thing in the family that they should know about, such as the ill character of stealing, ailment that could be hereditary, mental issues that could affect their future generations, etc. It is a process of finding out if their bride or groom to be was raised well and not known for exhibition of socially bad or unacceptable characters or histories. They ask all the necessary questions they need answers to. This is done by identifying members from each of those communities who know the families they are talking about. They gather their findings and then decide if they are going to proceed with the process or not.

iii. I mata ihe isi Nwaanyi- Marriage requirment.

After the investigation and findings, they then proceed with the process only if there were OK with whatever they found after the during the investigation. So here the family of the intended groom comes back to the family of the intended bride to seek the requirements for coming back to Mary dear daughter we now have negotiation if the requirement is so high and they until they agree on something some of these requirements could go from how many tubers of yam they would have to bring if they would need a goat if they would need some beads in jewelry um food item how many cola nuts and also G and the rest of it in the past they could ask how many shillings how many calories shells or Manila shells all of these requirements will be brought during the next process during the next stage of the process.

iv. Ime ego Nwaanyi ...Bride price

After learning of the marriage requirements, the family of the groom who would then proceed to discuss a date with the family of the bride on when they would be coming back to carry out the marriage rite. This we called ime ego isi Nwaanyi. Here all the requirements are brought to traditionally marry the lady. Both families would be come together to do this. It wis done in the ladys family. There is representation of the kinsmen “Ụmụnna, and the Kinswomen “Ụmụada.”

- **v. Igba nkwụ Nwaanyị... The Traditional Wedding Ceremony**

- Now after the ime ego Nwaanyị, it is now time for the celebration of the traditional wedding ceremony. Here the entire community could be invited in a large-scale celebration. or you could just be in a smaller scale between the families and of course some of the representative of the different groups.



- The traditional wedding ceremony is colorful event that announces, and bears witness to the marriage between the man and the woman. In this ceremony, there would be different dances- **egwu**, different delicacies- **erimeri**, beautiful traditional attires- **akwa ndi** Igbo, breaking of the **kolanut**. The bride search for here groom in the crowd to hand him a cup of nkwụ elu. That is the way for the public to bear witness. This event could also be done together with the previous stage if negotiations were agreed upon.





Vii. Idu Ụlọ - Bride's sendoff

- This where the family of the bride send her off with her dowry. This is in form of properties or even money that she would then take to her new husband's home.



viii. I dulata Nwaanyi/ ! nabata Nwaanyi - Welcoming the newly married wife home.

After the marriage ceremony, the family of the groom leads the wife home. They could also have a small welcome ceremony for her and people from the community and extended family members who did not make it would be coming to welcome her.

ix. I mata ʊlo – Visit of the Bride's Family to know their daughters new home.

After a while, the family of the bride would visit her to know where their daughter is married to. She and her husband would entertain them during this visit.

Iri Ji- New yam festival.

New yam festival is a great feast in Igbo land. It is a feast of thanksgiving after the harvest.

Some part of Igbo land call it 'Iwa Ji festival, Ahajiokụ. Iwa ji, ike ji, while others call it 'Iri Ji.' It a culture ndi Igbo uses to celebrate and eat new yams yearly.

The different communities celebrate it once a year.

- Yam is the most revered food/tuber by the Igbo land. In the past, wealth is measured by the size of a persons' yam ban. The wealthiest usually had the largest yam ban. Ndi Igbo show great respect to yam.



- There are different types of yams; **ji Abana** and **ji Amadi**. Ndi Igbo do not celebrate the new yam festival using Abana at all. The Amadi yam is used. Any celebration in Igbo land where yam is presented; such as the New yam festival, Marriage ceremony, Child visitation, and Offering; the Amadi yam is presented.



- Ndị Igbo cook different kinds of food with Yam, such as
- Ụtara ji na ofe- Pounded yam and soup
- Ji mmiri ọkụ- Hot water yam
- Ji e ghere eghe- Fried yam
- ji a hụrụ ahụ- Roasted yam
- Ji na mmanụ- Yam eaten with oil
- It is also used to prepare the ofe Nsala.



The new yam festival is a great feast that unites all Igbo people together. Brethren, the people of the community, friends, and neighbours come together to celebrate and eat the new yam, dance, celebrate or take titles, and rejoice together.

It is a great event that shows the beautiful culture and identity of Ndi Igbo.



• Mmemme
Ofala

- This is an annual ceremony practiced mainly communities in Anambra, particularly Onitsha, Nnewi, Ụmụeri, Ụmụoji, Ụkpọ and so on. It is derived from the words **ọfọ** and **Ala**. It is a yearly renewal of the king. An annual customary obligation. The celebration is traced back to the 16th century.

•- **!kwa ozu – The Burial Ceremony**

- This is the burial ceremony of the Igbo people. More like celebration of the dead. The Igbo burial ceremony is a whole event... almost to like a festival. The Igbo world view do not believe that death is an end to life, but a transition to an ancestral world. The also believe that until the burial rite is done, the spirit of the dead would not rest. We also believe in reincarnation.



ANTHONY

Itiputa Mmụọnwụ -The Masquerade Ceremony

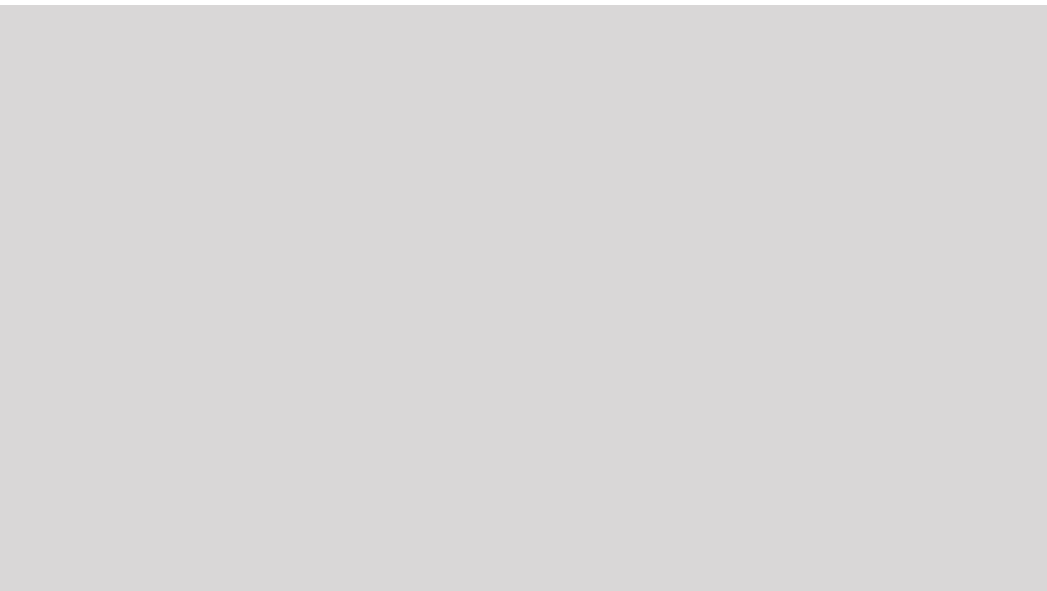
- The masquerade culture of the Igbo people. This is done exclusively by the masquerade secret societies or cult groups. It is a festival of masquerades. They would come out in their numbers to entertain the communities. This outings would be with elaborate, colorful costumes that are meant to invoke ancestral spirits.





Igụ afo/ Igu aro festival. The Igbo new year

The **Igụ-Aro** is celebrated to mark the beginning of a new year, which falls in the feburay month. There will be masqurdes, music, dances and lots of food. It is the proclamation and celebrations of the new year, majorly celebrated by Nri and neighboring communities in Anambra.



- The Igbo calendar is made up of four market days, namely Èké, Óriè, Àfò, Nkwọ.
- These four market days make up the Igbo week – Izu.
- Seven (7) of these Izu make up an Ọnwa (Month), and
- the Igbo Calendar has 13 Ọnwa (months).

Ògùàfò Ìgbò

No.	Months (Ọnwa)	Gregorian equivalent
1	Ọnwa Mbụ	(February–March)
2	Ọnwa Abụo	(March–April)
3	Ọnwa Ife Eke	(April–May)
4	Ọnwa Anọ	(May–June)
5	Ọnwa Agwụ	(June–July)
6	Ọnwa Ifejiọkụ	(July–August)
7	Ọnwa Alọm Chi	(August to early September)
8	Ọnwa Ilo Mmụọ	(Late September)
9	Ọnwa Ana	(October)
10	Ọnwa Okike	(Early November)
11	Ọnwa Ajana	(Late November)
12	Ọnwa Ede Ajana	(Late November to December)
13	Ọnwa Ụzọ Alụsị	(January to early February) ^{[1]}

AJÜJÜ